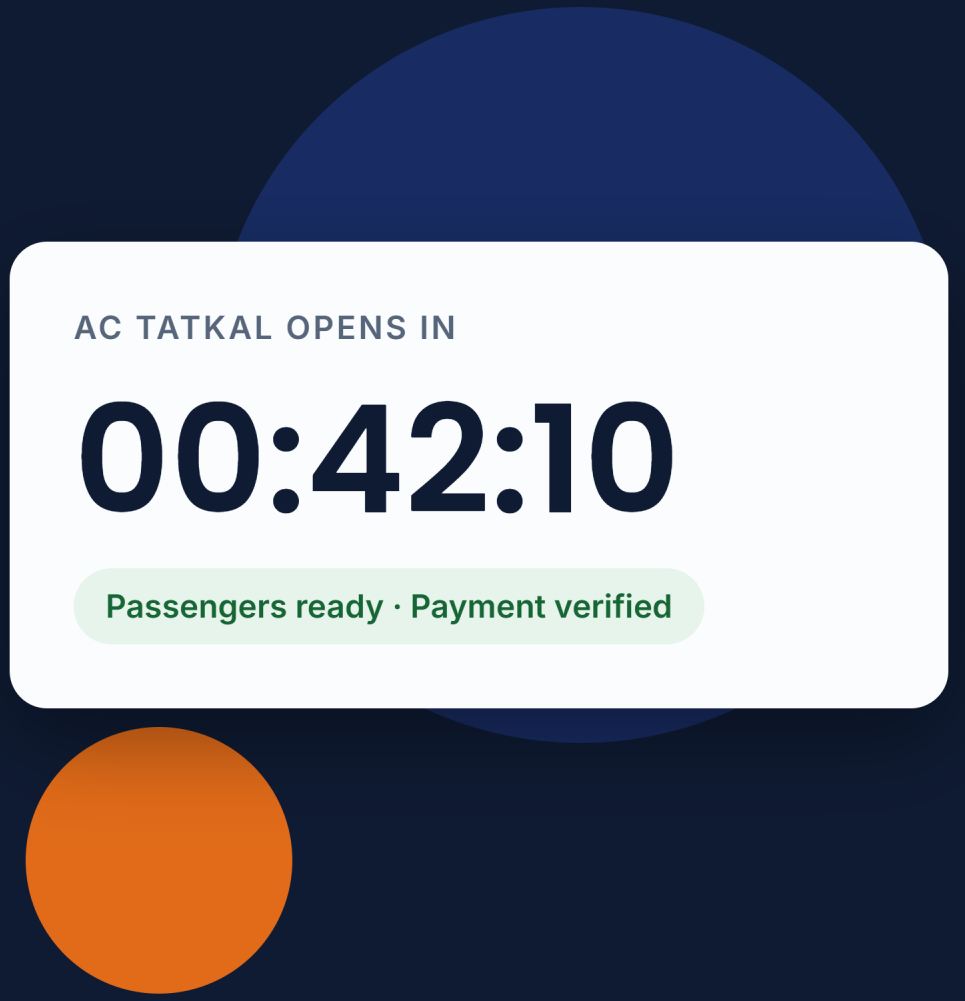
TATKAL BOOKING, REBUILT

TatkalPro

Book Tatkal without losing your ticket.

Prepared bookings, protected payments, fair queues and mistake-proof checks.



Prototype on simulated railway data · November 2026

Why Tatkal booking fails

Slow, fragile forms

Names, IDs and captcha are typed under pressure, and a timeout wipes the progress.

Payment limbo

Money is deducted but no ticket appears, with no live status and no clear next step.

An unfair rush

Scripts and multi-account abuse crowd out real people when seats are few.

Irreversible mistakes

Confirmed Tatkal tickets are generally non-refundable, so one slip costs the full fare.

THE INSIGHT

Users don’t fail at Tatkal because they’re slow. They fail because the system loses their progress.

TatkalPro prepares, protects and explains every booking.

Live passenger management

- Add, edit, remove, duplicate and reorder passengers at any time, even after Review.
- Fare, seat check and validation refresh instantly as the list changes.
- Every removal has an Undo, and drafts autosave and resume after a reload.
- Prepare everything before the window opens, so only “Book Now” is left.



Payment recovery

Hold

Seat held

Hold timer stays visible

Failure

Pay fails

UPI times out or errors

Recovery

Fallback

Switches to another method

Success

Confirmed

Ticket and PNR are issued

Money deducted but no ticket?

Automatic reconciliation starts at once, and a live refund tracker shows every step, so nobody is left on a blank screen.

Bot Shield

Defensive layers that make abuse costly while real users feel no extra friction.

Layer	What it does
Waiting room	Fair queue, then a signed, single-use booking pass
Rate limits	Per account, IP, device and phone number
Risk scoring	Timing and device signals only, no keystroke content stored
Adaptive challenge	Low risk: none. Medium: captcha. High: OTP. Very high: temporary block with appeal
Admin view	Live blocked requests, flagged devices and a false-positive log

Goal: raise the cost of abuse, not promise to eliminate bots.

THE HIDDEN PROBLEM

Tatkal Safety Net

Confirmed Tatkal tickets are generally non-refundable, so one rushed slip costs the full fare.

Regret Shield

Catches wrong station, date, class and passenger data mistakes before you pay

ID and travel-day readiness

Shows whose ID is on the ticket and reminds you before departure

Group Split Coordinator

Plans multi-PNR bookings for groups above four, with a Plan B

Failure Autopsy

Explains why an attempt failed and what to change next time

EXAMPLE: REGRET SHIELD

You searched New Delhi (NDLS) but picked Delhi Junction (DLI). Switch before you pay?

Switch to NDLS | Keep DLI

Silent when all is fine. One tap to fix when it isn't.

Rules are configurable and must be checked against official Indian Railways sources.

Everything else that removes stress

Problem	TatkalPro’s answer
Waitlist doubt	Confirmation probability with a plain explanation, plus nearby dates, trains, stations and classes
Surprise fees	Full fare (base, Tatkal charge, GST, gateway fee) shown upfront
Captcha and timeouts	Accessible captcha that never wipes the form, with autosaved drafts
Scams	Fake-link and UPI-request warnings, plus a verified-domain badge
After booking	E-ticket, live PNR status, refund calculator and calendar reminder

Design and technology

Design

Light, calm palette with soft blue, a warm orange action colour and pastel status chips.

Familiar IRCTC flow: stations, class, quota, train cards, passengers, payment.

Large tap targets, WCAG AA contrast, English and Hindi.

Designed in Figma first, then built from the file.

Technology

Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind and shadcn/ui.

In-memory mock railway API, so the app runs with a single dev command.

Optional Postgres, Redis and live updates through Docker Compose.

Configurable rules engine with a last-verified date.

Two-minute demo

1	0:00	Countdown and a prepared booking
2	0:20	Add and remove passengers while the fare updates live
3	0:45	Regret Shield catches a wrong station
4	1:15	Payment fails, falls back, and the ticket is confirmed
5	1:45	Admin dashboard shows the bots that were blocked

Honest scope

The prototype shows

- The booking experience, from countdown to confirmed ticket
- Payment failure recovery and refund tracking
- Bot Shield layers and the admin view
- Safety Net checks driven by a configurable rules file

Production would need

- Official IRCTC partner API access and legal approval
- Live payment gateway and bank integrations
- Bot Shield raises the cost of abuse and cannot eliminate bots
- Rules checked against official Indian Railways sources before each release

TATKALPRO

Other apps help you book faster. TatkalPro makes sure you don’t lose or ruin the ticket.

Prepare | Protect | Recover

Prototype on simulated railway data. Production needs official partner access.